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## COUNTY OF ALLEGHENY

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### **Onorato, Surma Announce Major Acquisition for Great Allegheny Passage**

*U. S. Steel transfers 1.5 miles of former pipeline property to Regional Trail Corporation*

**PITTSBURGH** — Allegheny County Chief Executive Dan Onorato and United States Steel Corporation Chairman & Chief Executive Officer John Surma today announced a major acquisition for the Great Allegheny Passage (GAP), the 335-mile biking and hiking trail stretching from Point State Park to Washington, D.C., and on to Mount Vernon, Va. U. S. Steel has removed a former coke-oven gas pipeline in West Mifflin and Duquesne and transferred the 1.5 miles of property to the Regional Trail Corporation.

“A year ago, John Surma and I agreed to co-chair the ‘Closing the Gaps in the GAP’ initiative, and now, thanks to U. S. Steel’s efforts, a former brownfield site will be opened to the public for recreational use,” said Onorato. “Property that was once a key to our industrial strength will now add to our region’s tourism and recreational strength. It’s appropriate that on the day we’ve once again been named America’s Most Livable City, we’re taking a major step to further improving our quality of life. I want to thank U. S. Steel and John Surma for providing this important missing link in the completion of the Great Allegheny Passage.”

U. S. Steel has become an important supporter of the Passage’s completion. In removing the former coke-oven gas pipeline, U. S. Steel completed much of the preparation work for trail development, such as addressing existing drainage issues and clearing the trail surface.

“United States Steel Corporation and its employees place a high value on the ideal of good corporate citizenship, and we’re proud to be a partner in a project that will have numerous benefits for the region we’ve called home for more than 105 years,” said Surma. “Once

completed, the Great Allegheny Passage will enhance the quality of life in Western Pennsylvania and serve as a dynamic pathway for visitors to experience our region's unique qualities and history. We're pleased to formally transfer 1.5 miles of historically significant property today and look forward to partnering with Allegheny County Chief Executive Dan Onorato, the Regional Trail Corporation and the Allegheny Trail Alliance in the effort to bridge the remaining gaps in the passage."

The Great Allegheny Passage travels through a scenic and historic corridor, roughly following early footpaths leading west from the tidal areas of Virginia. The final gaps in the trail are between McKeesport and the City of Pittsburgh in what is known as the Steel Valley section. The Allegheny Trail Alliance is building and maintaining the Great Allegheny Passage.

"This is yet another indication of the tremendous and steadfast support for this trail from both County and corporate leadership," said Allegheny Trail Alliance President Linda McKenna Boxx. "In no uncertain terms, this final section is the most challenging. We finished the southern connection to Maryland last year, and we're working hard to make the connection to Point State Park by next fall."

Completion of the Great Allegheny Passage is a signature project of the Pittsburgh 250 Commission to celebrate the region's 250<sup>th</sup> Anniversary in 2008.

"Allegheny County is taking a real leadership role," said Steel Valley Trail Council President Hannah Hardy. "We can move quickly into design and construction, and we hope to be breaking ground on several sections of what we call 'the gaps in the GAP' by early summer. Without the commitment and focus of Dan Onorato, we could not possibly achieve this in time for the 250<sup>th</sup> Anniversary celebration of the region next year."

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*Additional information about the Great Allegheny Passage is available at [www.atatrail.org](http://www.atatrail.org).*

*For information regarding the 250<sup>th</sup> Anniversary of the Pittsburgh region, visit [www.imaginepittsburgh.com](http://www.imaginepittsburgh.com).*